

The Most Holy Trinity

Year A — May 31, 2026

PC-S58-A: U.S. Roman Missal, Third Edition; Lectionary no. 164

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	“Blest be God the Father...”
Collect	<i>Deus Pater, qui, Verbum veritatis...</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	Exod. 34:4b–6, 8–9
Responsorial Canticle	Dan. 3:52–56; single response from v. 52b
Second Reading	2 Cor. 13:11–13
Gospel acclamation	cf. Rev. 1:8
Gospel	John 3:16–18
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over the Offerings	<i>Sanctifica... per tui nominis invocationem</i>
Proper Preface	<i>The mystery of the Most Holy Trinity</i>
Communion Antiphon	Gal. 4:6
Prayer after Communion	<i>Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae</i>

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Exodus narrates covenant renewal; Daniel’s Greek canticle praises from the furnace; Paul closes conflict with reconciliation and a triadic blessing; John reflects on the saving gift of the Son; Galatians voices adoption through the Spirit.
Allegorical	The one God’s Sinai mercy is heard, within the full Christian canon and rule of faith, through the Father’s sending of the Son and Spirit and the Church’s communion in their one divine life. This does not assign Nicene vocabulary to every earlier author.
Moral	Worshippers are summoned to adore, believe, come to the light, mend relationships, live in peace, and let adopted life become an enduring offering rather than a merely verbal profession.
Anagogical	Eternal life, divine indwelling, confession of the eternal Trinity, and unending doxology disclose the communion toward which sacramental reception and the whole Christian life are ordered.

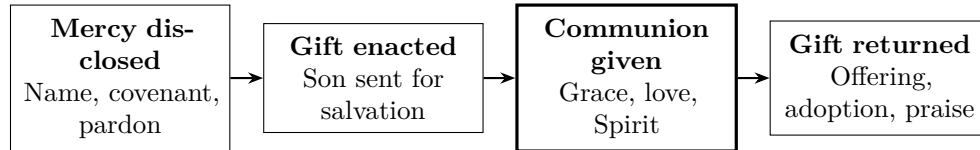
In Illo Tempore...

Catholic canonical order governs; composition rows distinguish historical judgment from narrated settings, adaptations retain their source marker, and the table supplies orientation rather than protected biblical text.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
First Reading	Exod. 34:4b–6, 8–9	Israel; final literary place unknown	First millennium BC; exact date unresolved
<i>Narrated event</i>	Exod. 32–34	Sinai wilderness	After the Exodus; exact historical date unresolved
The pericope belongs to covenant renewal after the golden calf. Moses ascends with replacement tablets; the Lord proclaims the divine name and covenantal qualities; Moses worships and asks pardon and presence for a stiff-necked people. The official Exodus introduction gives no precise composition date. Traditional Mosaic framing and the text's complex literary formation are therefore distinguished rather than harmonized.			
Responsorial Canticle	Dan. 3:52–56	Greek-speaking Jewish milieu; exact composition site unknown	Greek addition: exact date unknown; Daniel's final form 167–164 BC
<i>Narrated event</i>	Dan. 3:1–90	Babylon, present-day Iraq	Sixth-century-BC story world
The response belongs to the Greek Prayer of Azariah and Song of the Three inserted into Daniel 3. The book's final form addresses persecution under Antiochus IV, but the addition's own author, place, and date remain unproved. The furnace is a narrated setting, not evidence of composition in Babylon.			
Gospel	John 3:16–18	Ephesus traditionally; Syria or Antioch possible	Final editing c. AD 90–100
<i>Narrated event</i>	John 2:23–3:21	Jerusalem at Passover	Jesus' early ministry; exact year unresolved
The passage is the evangelist's reflection after the Nicodemus dialogue. The Father's giving embraces Incarnation and Cross; the stated purpose is salvation, while response to the light discloses present judgment. These verses name God and the Son directly; their full Trinitarian hearing comes from the wider Gospel and liturgical formula.			
Second Reading	2 Cor. 13:11–13	Macedonia; audience at Corinth, Greece	Autumn c. AD 57
Paul's final blessing follows appeals for restoration, encouragement, agreement, and peace after a wounded relationship with Corinth. It is one of the New Testament's clearest triadic witnesses. Older witnesses call the blessing verse 14; the U.S. Lectionary calls it verse 13.			
Communion Antiphon	Gal. 4:6	Ephesus or another Pauline mission site; disputed	c. AD 48–50 or 54–55
The North and South Galatian theories yield different dates and settings. The immediate audience is Gentile believers pressured toward Mosaic observance. The verse belongs to an argument about emancipation and adoption: God sends the Son and the Spirit of the Son so heirs may address the Father.			
Gospel acclamation	cf. Rev. 1:8	Roman Asia; exact final writing site uncertain	Near the end of Domitian's reign (AD 81–96)
Revelation addresses seven churches living under imperial pressure. The Lectionary takes the divine title of Revelation 1:8 and gives it explicit Trinitarian form. Its <i>cf.</i> label matters: the liturgical verse is an adaptation, not a verbatim sentence by the seer.			

The Propers: Themes and Movement

This solemnity moves from God's self-disclosure to the Church's participation: mercy is proclaimed, the Son is given, the Spirit forms communion and filial speech, and worshippers return the gift in confession and offering. The unity is liturgical and doctrinal; it is not attributed as one literary design to the several biblical authors.



Mercy Reveals the One God (*Entrance, Collect, First Reading, Canticle*)

The non-scriptural Entrance Antiphon blesses Father, Son, and Spirit for merciful love before the Collect names the missions of Word and sanctifying Spirit. Exodus supplies the covenantal grammar beneath that praise: God freely proclaims the divine Name and qualities, while Moses responds with worship and a plea for pardoning presence. Daniel then makes the response doxological from within persecution. The movement is revelation, adoration, petition, and blessing—not a deduction of three Persons from repeated Old Testament phrases.

Doctrinal guardrail — Catechism 236–237, 253–258

The works by which God reveals and gives himself truly disclose the Trinity, yet the Old Testament does not thereby become an explicit Nicene treatise. One divine nature and one common operation exclude three competing gods; real personal distinction excludes three temporary masks.

The Gift of the Son Discloses Salvation and Judgment (*Acclamation, Gospel*)

The adapted acclamation names the eternal Trinity before John proclaims the Father's gift of the Son. John holds purpose and crisis together: the Son is sent to save, not to seek condemnation, but the light's coming exposes the response of belief or refusal. Augustine's direct exposition keeps the medicinal image central. Salvation is offered through the crucified and exalted Son; judgment is not an arbitrary divine delight in ruin.

Apostolic Blessing Becomes Ecclesial Form (*Second Reading*)

Paul's blessing does not float above the preceding imperatives. Grace, love, and communion crown a call to repair, encouragement, agreement, and peace. Chrysostom sees the three named sources without dividing divine gifts into separate economies. The solemnity therefore places dogmatic confession inside a concrete ecclesial task: a people blessed in Trinitarian form is to become reconciled and peaceable.

Decisive boundary

The apostolic blessing is authentic triadic revelation, but the guide does not claim that Paul already wrote the technical vocabulary of Nicaea and Constantinople. Later dogma protects the apostolic witness from tritheist, modalist, and subordinationist misreadings.

Confession Passes into Offering and Adoption (*Prayer over Offerings, Preface, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings asks that invocation of the divine Name sanctify both the gifts and the worshippers' enduring self-offering. The Preface supplies exact doctrinal grammar: distinct Persons, one substance, equal majesty. At Communion, Galatians makes confession lived relationship; the Spirit of the Son voices adopted address to the Father. The final prayer asks that sacramental reception and confessed faith profit body and soul. Doctrine, sacrament, and life remain distinguishable but inseparable.

Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

The appointed texts lead from the one God's covenantal mercy to the Father's gift of the Son and the Spirit's work of communion. Read within the Church's rule of faith, Sinai, the Johannine mission, Paul's apostolic blessing, and the proper Preface converge in confession of three distinct Persons, one divine substance, and one saving work, while each biblical text retains its own historical horizon.

That confession has an ecclesial and moral shape. Moses bows and intercedes; Daniel blesses; John summons faith and movement into the light; Paul joins the Trinitarian blessing to reconciliation and peace. The orations turn the same movement into worship by asking that the divine Name sanctify both gifts and people and that sacramental reception form an enduring offering. The Communion Antiphon gives this life a filial voice as the Spirit of the Son addresses the Father. The final prayer carries profession and reception toward the salvation of body and soul, locating Christian hope in full participation in divine life and unending doxology.

Dimension	Appointed anchors	Source-grounded synthesis	Limit
Trinitarian confession	Entrance; Collect; Second Reading; proper Preface	The missions of Word and Spirit, Paul's triadic blessing, and the Preface's confession of three Persons, one substance, and equal majesty order the solemnity toward adoration of the one God.	Nicene grammar protects the apostolic witness; it is not retrojected into every biblical author's vocabulary.
Saving gift	Gospel acclamation; Gospel	The adapted acclamation names the eternal Trinity, while John presents the Father's gift of the Son as ordered to salvation and received in faith.	The acclamation retains its <i>cf.</i> status; John 3:16–18 does not name all three Persons or make judgment unreal.
Ecclesial conversion	First Reading; Canticle; Second Reading; Prayer over the Offerings	Pardoned covenant life elicits worship and intercession; apostolic blessing takes communal shape in repair and peace; the gifts lead worshippers toward enduring self-offering.	Mercy neither denies sin nor makes human offering an independent saving sacrifice.
Adoption and hope	Communion Antiphon; Prayer after Communion	The Spirit of the Son gives filial address to the Father, and sacramental reception with confessed faith tends toward salvation of body and soul, divine communion, and unending praise.	Filial intimacy is ecclesial rather than automatic, private, or disembodied.

The Propers: Detailed Commentary

Entrance: Doxology before Analysis (*Entrance Antiphon*)

The Entrance Antiphon is a composed liturgical blessing rather than an attributed biblical quotation. It names Father, the Only Begotten Son, and Holy Spirit and gives one reason for praise: divine merciful love. The sequence is important. The assembly does not begin by treating the mystery as an object placed at intellectual distance; it receives itself as a people already addressed by mercy and therefore capable of confession.

Collect: Missions Ordered to Profession (*Collect*)

The Collect addresses the Father and recalls the sending of the Word of truth and the Spirit of sanctification. It then asks that servants profess the true faith by acknowledging the glory of the eternal Trinity and adoring Unity in almighty majesty. The prayer's order moves from divine action to ecclesial confession: revelation and sanctification precede profession.

Prayer movement	Doctrinal work	Limit retained
Word of truth sent	The Son's mission is revelatory and personal, not the arrival of an impersonal message.	The mission in time does not begin the Son's existence.
Spirit of sanctification sent	Knowledge of God is joined to transformation and worship.	The Spirit is not reduced to an effect, mood, or created force.
Trinity acknowledged; Unity adored	Real distinction and one divine life are confessed together.	Neither three gods nor one Person wearing three names is admitted.

Catechism 236 provides the controlling distinction: the economy reveals the divine life without exhausting it. The prayer can move from sending to confession because the temporal missions manifest who the Son and Spirit eternally are; it cannot license collapsing eternal processions into visible historical events.

Exodus and Daniel: Mercy Answered by Blessing (*First Reading, Responsorial Canticle*)

Exodus 34 comes after rupture. Israel has worshipped the calf; Moses has shattered the tablets; intercession and threatened absence expose the covenant's crisis. The appointed passage does not minimize sin. It places pardon within God's free self-proclamation and Moses' bold request that the Lord accompany, forgive, and take this people as an inheritance.

Textual moment	Literal action	Liturgical fruit	Misreading excluded
Replacement tablets	Covenant words are received again after infidelity.	The assembly hears mercy as restoration, not denial of sin.	Grace is not permission to call the calf harmless.
Divine proclamation	God names mercy, fidelity, justice, and patience.	Trinitarian worship begins from the one God's revealed identity.	Repeated titles are not three hidden Persons.
Moses bows	Revelation elicits bodily worship and intercession.	Doctrine tends toward adoration and prayer for a people.	Mystery is not mastered as abstract data.
Daniel responds	The persecuted bless God across heaven, sanctuary, throne, and depths.	The response widens covenant mercy into doxology.	The Greek canticle is not mislabeled Hebrew.

The Daniel verses belong to a later Greek addition, yet the Church receives them canonically as Scripture. Historical candor about literary formation does not weaken their liturgical authority; conversely, canonical authority does not

require inventing a Babylonian composition date. Their responsorial force is plain: before asking how the one God is three Persons, the assembly blesses the God whose mercy makes worship possible.

Second Reading: A Blessing with Ethical Syntax (*Second Reading*)

Paul begins the pericope with imperatives and closes with greeting and blessing. Restoration, encouragement, agreement, and peace are not detachable preliminaries. They are the communal shape within which grace, divine love, and the Spirit's communion are invoked. The God of love and peace is promised in a sentence that also commands the wounded Corinthians to seek reconciliation.

St. John Chrysostom — *Homily 30 on 2 Corinthians, 3*

Commenting directly on the final blessing, Chrysostom observes the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit named together and refuses to partition their gifts as though each Person acted independently. His older numbering says 13:14; the U.S. Lectionary says 13:13.

The text is a strong apostolic ground for Trinitarian confession, but its order should be preserved. "Grace" does not make the Son lesser than the Father; "love" does not belong to the Father alone; "communion" does not reduce the Spirit to a shared human feeling. Augustine's rule of inseparable operation and the proper Preface's equality of majesty keep the invocation from being divided into three competing benefactors.

Acclamation and Gospel: The Saving Gift in the Light (*Gospel acclamation, Gospel*)

The acclamation is explicitly marked *cf.* Revelation 1:8. It takes the eternal divine title and gives it a Trinitarian liturgical form. The adaptation is legitimate appointed text, but exact source discipline matters: Revelation's author is not made to say the added formula in that verse. Acclamatory function, not proof-text arithmetic, governs its place.

John 3:16–18 stands within a conversation about birth from above, Spirit, testimony, the heavenly descent of the Son of Man, and the lifted serpent. The appointed verses concentrate on divine initiative: God loves, gives, and sends; the Son is received in faith; eternal life is offered. The exclusion of verses 19–21 does not erase the light-and-darkness explanation that immediately follows.

St. Augustine — *Tractate 12 on John, 11–13*

Augustine reads the lifted serpent as a healing sign and insists that Christ's coming is ordered to salvation. Condemnation is disclosed where the sick person refuses the offered remedy and avoids the light. His reading holds together divine mercy, the Cross, faith, confession, and moral conversion.

Trinitarian and pastoral guardrail

The appointed Gospel directly names God and the only Son; it does not name all three Persons within verses 16–18. The Spirit belongs to the preceding discourse and the whole Johannine witness. The feast's Trinitarian synthesis is canonical and liturgical, not a false claim about the pericope's isolated wording. Likewise, universal saving purpose does not imply that faith and judgment are unreal.

Prayer over the Offerings: The Gift Returned (*Prayer over the Offerings*)

The proper prayer asks sanctification through invocation of the divine Name and moves from the gifts to the worshippers themselves as an enduring offering. It does not make human self-dedication an independent saving sacrifice. The Eucharistic action precedes and forms ecclesial self-offering; worshippers ask God to accomplish what they cannot manufacture.

St. Augustine — *City of God* X.5–6, 20

Augustine is not commenting on this prayer. He supplies doctrinal illumination: visible sacrifice signifies the interior offering that joins a person to God, and the redeemed city offers itself through Christ the one High Priest and sacrifice. The order preserves both Christ's uniqueness and the Church's real participation.

Proper Preface: The Rule that Guards the Feast (*Preface*)

The Preface prevents the formula's biblical variety from becoming a loose collection of devotional images. It confesses one God and Lord, not one solitary Person; distinction belongs to Persons, unity to substance, equality to majesty. This is liturgical dogma within thanksgiving, not a speculative appendix after the practical texts.

Confessed term	Affirmation	Error excluded	Effect on reading
Three Persons	Father, Son, and Spirit are really distinct.	Modalism or three passing roles.	Missions and triadic blessings concern personal subjects.
One substance	The divine nature is numerically one.	Tritheism or a society of gods.	Mercy and saving operation are one divine work.
Equal majesty	No Person is lesser in divinity.	Subordinationism.	Sending and reception do not imply created inferiority.
One adoration	The Church's thanksgiving is directed to the triune God.	Partitioned worship.	Biblical strands end in one doxology.

Communion: Adoption as Trinitarian Life (*Communion Antiphon*)

Galatians 4:6 is short enough to be misheard as a decorative proof text. In context, Paul argues that God acts before the heir's response: the Son is sent for redemption and adoption; the Spirit of the Son is sent into hearts; filial address to the Father follows. The antiphon therefore makes Communion relational without reducing it to private intimacy.

Pauline movement	Trinitarian form	Moral consequence
The Son is sent	Redemption and adoption are received through Christ.	Christian freedom is not self-originating autonomy.
The Spirit is sent into hearts	Divine communion becomes interior and ecclesial life.	The Spirit is more than a religious emotion.
The Father is addressed	The baptized live as heirs rather than slaves.	Filial confidence must become obedience and peace.

Prayer after Communion: Confession for the Whole Person (*Prayer after Communion*)

The final prayer joins two realities without confusing them: reception of the sacrament and confession of the eternal Trinity and undivided Unity. Both are asked to advance salvation of body and soul. The prayer therefore refuses a disembodied intellectualism and a sacramental automatism. Reception and confessed faith are gifts ordered toward continuing transformation of the whole person.

The Propers: Interpretive Possibilities

The proposals below are original editorial or AI-generated possibilities. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities, claim no common historical compositional intent, and remain bounded by the alternatives stated.

A grammar of gift. (*Collect, Gospel, Communion*) The Collect recalls Father, Word, and sanctifying Spirit; the Gospel proclaims the Son given for salvation; Communion voices the Spirit of the Son addressing the Father. Their liturgical conjunction suggests a grammar in which divine life is first received and only then returned as confession and praise. The proposal does not make the processions a temporal sequence, nor claim that John and Paul composed one coordinated argument.

From the Name to communion. (*First Reading, Second Reading, Communion*) Exodus proclaims the covenantal Name, 2 Corinthians invokes grace, love, and communion, and Galatians voices filial address. Read canonically, the sequence may trace movement from the God who dwells with a pardoned people to participation in divine life. This is a liturgical arc, not literary dependence, and Exodus must retain its own Israelite horizon rather than being reduced to a coded Trinitarian formula.

Mercy before metaphysics. (*Entrance, First Reading, Preface*) The Entrance and Exodus place merciful initiative before the Preface's precise confession. This permits a pastoral claim: Nicene precision protects the identity of the merciful giver instead of replacing mercy with abstraction. Yet precision cannot be made optional whenever doctrinal language feels difficult, and "mercy before" describes the guide's pedagogical sequence rather than an order within God.

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Celebration	The Most Holy Trinity; solemnity of the Lord; Ordinary Time; white.
Identity	Parent PC-S58; formula key PC-S58-A; occurrence Sunday, May 31, 2026.
Books	<i>Missale Romanum</i> , third typical edition, emended 2008; U.S. English <i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> , implemented 2011; U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Volume I, no. 164.
Calendar	General Roman Calendar as used in the dioceses of the United States; national occurrence resolved for May 31, 2026.
Cycle	Production coverage and actual Sunday cycle: A; U.S. Lectionary no. 164.
Textual scope	Entrance Antiphon, Collect, Year A readings and canticle, Gospel acclamation, Prayer over the Offerings, proper Trinity Preface, Communion Antiphon, and Prayer after Communion.

References

- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (Vatican City: Typis Vaticanis, 2002), *In sollemnitatibus Domini per annum occurrentibus*, pp. 485–488; and reimpressio emendata (2008). Element and Latin-text collation: `../shared/formularies/pc-s58-most-holy-trinity/propers/verified.md`.
- *Roman Missal, Third Edition, for Use in the Dioceses of the United States of America*; official status and implementation in the USCCB GIRM foreword.
- USCCB, *Liturgical Calendar for the Dioceses of the United States of America: 2026*, pp. 5, 28; and Lectionary no. 164 occurrence page.
- Bishops' Conference of England and Wales, *Antiphonary: Excerpted from the Roman Missal* (2010), p. 84, official common-ICEL antiphon witness.
- Holy Scripture and official introductions: Exodus and chapters 32–34; Daniel and chapter 3; John and John 3; 2 Corinthians and chapter 13; Galatians; Revelation.
- *Catechism of the Catholic Church*, 232–267.
- Leo XIII, *Divinum illud munus*, 3.
- St. Augustine, *De Trinitate* I.4.7; *Tractate 12 on John*, 11–13; and *City of God* X.5–6, 20.
- St. Gregory Nazianzen, *Oration 40*, 41–43.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 30 on 2 Corinthians*, 3.

Search Scope and Limitations

Text. Year A Lectionary no. 164, its single Daniel response, the Latin formulary, proper Preface, and official ICEL antiphons were collated; complete U.S.-English oration collation against a named altar-book printing remains outstanding. **History.** Every direct passage and marked adaptation was studied in canonical order, with narrated events distinguished from composition. **Reception.** Direct Johannine and Pauline Fathers, classical Trinitarian witnesses, the Catechism, and one feast-history source were checked. **Review.** Internal source audit is complete for the recorded layers; independent theological, liturgical, biblical, and historical review is not. **Full records.** `instance/manifest.md`; `propers/verified.md`; `../shared/formularies/pc-s58-most-holy-trinity/propers/verified.md`; `research/scope.md`.

Generation Metadata

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